Viewership Analysis of *The Big Bang Theory*

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1 Introduction

The Big Bang Theory is an American television sitcom created by Chuck Lorre and Bill Prady for CBS. It aired from September 24, 2007, to May 16, 2019, running for 12 seasons and 279 episodes.

The show originally centered on five characters living in Pasadena, California: Leonard Hofstadter and Sheldon Cooper, both physicists at the California Institute of Technology, who share an apartment; Penny, a waitress and aspiring actress who lives across the hall; and Leonard and Sheldon's socially awkward friends and coworkers, aerospace engineer Howard Wolowitz and astrophysicist Raj Koothrappali.

Over time, supporting characters became important parts of the series, including neuroscientist Amy Farrah Fowler, microbiologist Bernadette Rostenkowski, and comic book store owner Stuart Bloom.

The series was filmed in front of a live audience and produced by Chuck Lorre Productions, with Warner Bros. Television handling distribution. Although the first season received mixed reviews, later seasons became highly successful. The show won several Emmy Awards, including four awards for Jim Parsons for his role as Sheldon Cooper.

The success of *The Big Bang Theory* also led to the creation of spin-off series such as *Young Sheldon* and *Georgie & Mandy's First Marriage*.

2 Images from the Show

Figure 1: Official logo of *The Big Bang Theory*

Figure 2: Main cast of *The Big Bang Theory*

3 Summary of Viewership Statistics

Season	Episodes	TV Season	Avg. Viewers (Millions)	Viewership Rank
1	17	2007–08	8.31	68
2	23	2008–09	10.03	40
3	23	2009–10	14.22	12
4	24	2010–11	13.21	13
5	24	2011–12	15.82	8
6	24	2012–13	18.68	3
7	24	2013–14	19.96	2
8	24	2014–15	19.05	2
9	24	2015–16	20.36	2
10	24	2016–17	18.99	2
11	24	2017–18	18.63	1
12	24	2018–19	17.31	2

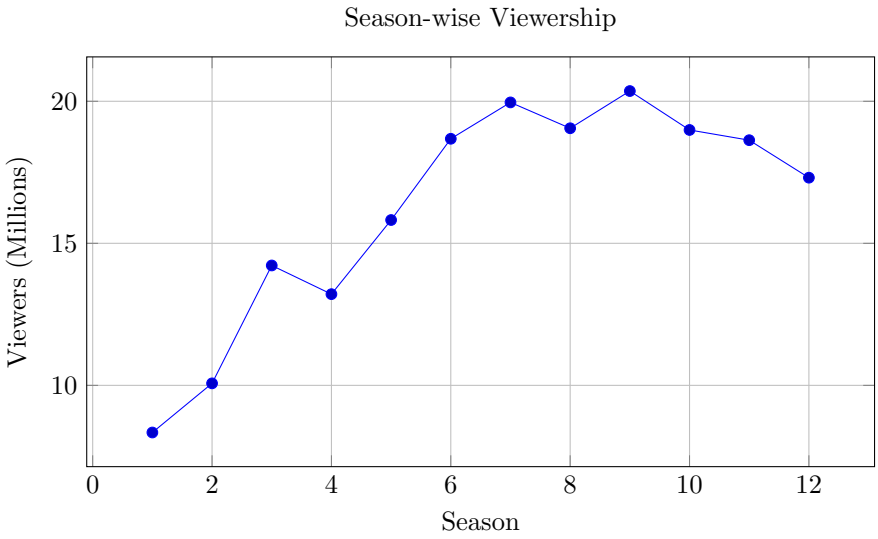
Table 1: Season-wise Viewership Statistics of *The Big Bang Theory*

The table above shows the average U.S. viewership of *The Big Bang Theory* across all 12 seasons. The series started with 8.31 million viewers in Season 1 and gradually became one of the most watched television sitcoms in the United States.

The highest average viewership was recorded in Season 9 with approximately 20.36 million viewers. The show also achieved the No. 1 television ranking during Season 11.

Although the final seasons experienced a slight decrease in audience numbers, the show remained highly successful until its conclusion in 2019.

4 Viewership Over Time



5 Observed Changes in Viewership

The data shows that the popularity of *The Big Bang Theory* increased significantly during its early seasons. The average viewership increased from 8.31 million viewers in Season 1 to 14.22 million viewers in Season 3, which is an increase of 5.91 million viewers.

A small decrease was observed between Seasons 3 and 4, where the average audience dropped from 14.22 million to 13.21 million viewers, a decrease of 1.01 million viewers.

The series continued to grow in popularity afterward. Between Seasons 4 and 7, the average viewership increased from 13.21 million to 19.96 million viewers, which represents a growth of 6.75 million viewers.

The highest average audience was recorded in Season 9 with 20.36 million viewers. However, after Season 9, the viewership gradually declined. Between Seasons 9 and 12, the audience decreased from 20.36 million to 17.31 million viewers, showing a drop of 3.05 million viewers.

Despite the decline in the final seasons, the show remained one of the most watched sitcoms on television throughout its run.